

CURRICULUM VITAE

Alexandria K. Vail

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Human-Computer Interaction Institute
Pittsburgh, PA 15213-3815

Education

- 2016 – **Ph.D.**, Human-Computer Interaction
Carnegie Mellon University
Advisor: Dr. Louis-Philippe Morency
- 2015 – 2016 **Ph.D. Student**, Computer Science
North Carolina State University
Advisors: Dr. Kristy Boyer, Dr. James Lester
- 2011 – 2015 **B.S.**, Computer Science, **B.S.**, Mathematics, *magna cum laude*, 3.6/4.0
North Carolina State University
- Minor concentrations: Cognitive Science, Physics
Phi Kappa Phi, Sigma Pi Sigma
University Honors, Computer Science Honors, Mathematics Honors

Research Experience

- 2016 – **Graduate Research Assistant**, Human-Computer Interaction Institute
Carnegie Mellon University
The MultiComp Lab
- 2015 – 2016 **Graduate Research Assistant**, Center for Educational Informatics
North Carolina State University
The LearnDialogue Group, The Intellimedia Group
- 2013 – 2015 **Undergraduate Researcher**, Center for Educational Informatics
North Carolina State University
The LearnDialogue Group

Research Interests

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE, ADVANCED LEARNING TECHNOLOGIES, NATURAL LANGUAGE PROCESSING

- ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE: user modeling, affective computing, AI & education, multimodal behavior analysis
- ADVANCED LEARNING TECHNOLOGIES: intelligent tutoring systems, tutorial dialogue, game-based learning environments
- NATURAL LANGUAGE PROCESSING: natural language understanding, natural language dialogue systems

Teaching Experience

2013 – 2014 **Teaching Assistant**, North Carolina State University
Department of Computer Science

Fall 2013 CSC 226: Discrete Mathematics for Computer Scientists
Dr. Tiffany Barnes
~250 students

Spring 2014 CSC 230: C and Software Tools
Dr. Sarah Heckman
~120 students

2012 – 2013 **Mathematics & Physics Tutor**, North Carolina State University
College Reading & Learning Association: Level II Advanced Tutor Certification

Publications

2016

1. **A. Vail**, J. Grafsgaard, K. Boyer, E. Wiebe, and J. Lester. Gender Differences in Facial Expressions of Affect During Learning. *Proceedings of the Twenty-Fourth International Conference on User Modelling, Adaptation, and Personalization (UMAP 2016)*, pp. 65–73, Halifax, Canada, 2016. (long paper, acceptance rate: 23.9%)

Outstanding Paper

2. **A. Vail**, J. Wiggins, J. Grafsgaard, K. Boyer, E. Wiebe, and J. Lester. The Affective Impact of Tutor Questions: Predicting Frustration and Engagement. *Proceedings of the Ninth International Conference on Educational Data Mining (EDM 2016)*, pp. 247–254, Raleigh, North Carolina, 2016. (long paper, acceptance rate: 27.5%)

Exemplary Paper

3. W. Min, J. Wiggins, L. Pezzullo, **A. Vail**, K. Boyer, B. Mott, M. Frankosky, E. Wiebe, and J. Lester. Predicting Dialogue Acts for Intelligent Virtual Agents with Multimodal Student Interaction Data. *Proceedings of the Ninth International Conference on Educational Data Mining (EDM 2016)*, pp. 454–459, Raleigh, North Carolina, 2016. (short paper, acceptance rate: 52%)
4. **A. Vail**, J. Grafsgaard, K. Boyer, E. Wiebe, and J. Lester. Predicting Learning from Student Affective Response to Tutor Questions. *Proceedings of the Thirteenth International Conference on Intelligent Tutoring Systems (ITS 2016)*, pp. 154–164, Zagreb, Croatia, 2016. (long paper, acceptance rate: 15%)

2015

5. **A. Vail**, K. Boyer, E. Wiebe, and J. Lester. The Mars and Venus Effect: The Influence of User Gender on the Effectiveness of Adaptive Task Support. *Proceedings of the Twenty-Third International Conference on User Modeling, Adaptation, and Personalization (UMAP 2015)*, pp. 216–227, Dublin, Ireland, 2015. (long paper, acceptance rate: 28%)

Best Paper Award

2014

6. **A. Vail**, J. Grafsgaard, J. Wiggins, J. Lester, and K. Boyer. Predicting Learning and Engagement in Tutorial Dialogue: A Personality-Based Model. *Proceedings of the Sixteenth ACM International Conference on Multimodal Interaction (ICMI 2014)*, pp. 255–262, Istanbul, Turkey, 2014. (long paper, acceptance rate: 39%)
7. J. Grafsgaard, J. Wiggins, **A. Vail**, K. Boyer, E. Wiebe, and J. Lester. The Additive Value of Multimodal Features for Predicting Engagement, Frustration, and Learning During Tutoring. *Proceedings of the Sixteenth ACM International Conference on Multimodal Interaction (ICMI 2014)*, pp. 42–49, Istanbul, Turkey, 2014. (long paper, acceptance rate: 39%)
8. **A. Vail** and K. Boyer. Adapting to Personality Over Time: Examining the Effectiveness of Dialogue Policy Progressions in Task-Oriented Interaction. *Proceedings of the Fifteenth Annual Meeting of the Special Interest Group on Discourse and Dialogue (SIGDIAL 2014)*, pp. 41–50, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania, 2014. (long paper, acceptance rate: 30%)
9. **A. Vail** and K. Boyer. Identifying Effective Moves in Tutoring: On the Refinement of Dialogue Act Annotation Schemes. *Proceedings of the Twelfth International Conference on Intelligent Tutoring Systems (ITS 2014)*, pp. 199–209, Honolulu, Hawaii, 2014. (long paper, acceptance rate: 17.5%)

Honors and Awards

- Best Paper Award, Twenty-Third Conference on User Modeling, Adaptation, and Personalization, 2015.
- National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship, 2015.
- North Carolina State University Department of Computer Science Senior Award for Scholarly Achievement, 2015.
- Generation Google Scholarship, 2014.
- North Carolina Society of Information Management Scholarship, 2013, 2014.
- Howard A. Petrea Endowed Scholarship in Mathematics, 2013.

Relevant Coursework

Graduate Coursework

Spoken Dialogue Systems
Computational Applied Logic
Numerical Analysis I
Reasoning Under Uncertainty
Human Communication and
Multimodal Computation

Artificial Intelligence I, II
Software Engineering
Combinatorics I
Graph Theory
Automated Learning and Data Analysis
Process and Theory in HCI

Undergraduate Coursework

Computer Organization and Assembly
Language for Computer Scientists

Foundations of Advanced Mathematics
Calculus I, II, III

C and Software Tools
Concepts and Facilities of Operating
Systems for Computer Scientists
Data Structures
Automata, Grammars, and
Computability
Ethics in Computing
Introduction to Artificial Intelligence

Technology & American Culture
The Creative Process in Science
Self, Schooling, & Social Order
Introduction to College Tutoring

Applied Differential Equations I
Introduction to Linear Algebra
Introduction to Modern Algebra for
Mathematicians
Introduction to Combinatorics
Probability and Statistics for Engineers
Mathematical Analysis I, II
Mathematics of Scientific Computing
Symbolic Logic

Introduction to Language & Linguistics
Introduction to Cognitive Science
Introduction to Psychology
Cognitive Processes

Professional Membership

- Association for Computing Machinery (ACM).
- Association for the Advancement of Affective Computing (AAAC).
- International Artificial Intelligence in Education Society (IAIED).
- Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE).
- International Educational Data Mining Society (IEDMS).
- Students & Technology in Academia, Research, and Service (STARS) Student Leadership Corps.
- Mensa International.

References

Dr. Kristy Boyer

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Department of Computer and
Information Science and
Engineering
University of Florida
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Dr. James Lester

Distinguished Professor &
Director of the Center for
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Dr. Tiffany Barnes

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